

HOW TO RECOGNIZE A DEFINITION

A short guide

1. What's a definition?

- A **definition** is an explanation of the meaning of a term .
- A **term** is a word or phrase.



Where do you find definitions?

The best place to find a definition is in a **dictionary**.

2. Parts of a definition



1

The
TERM.

2

The GROUP of
objects or
concept to
which the term
belongs.

3

The special
CHARACTERISTICS
that make the
term different
from others in its
group.

Examples

Water



1. The **term**



Water is ...

2. The **group** of object which the term belongs

✓ ... a liquid ...



3. The **special characteristics** that make

✓ ... made of two molecules of hydrogen and one of oxygen ...



“Water is a liquid made up of two molecules of hydrogen and one of oxygen”.

3. How to recognize a definition

a. Algunas expresiones o indicadores se usan para definir o explicar una oración en forma explícita:

*means - refers to - denotes - is defined as - is taken to be -
by... we mean
by... is meant - in other words*

- *The term computer refers to the processor plus the internal memory.*

b. Otro método que se usa es utilizando el verbo “TO BE” cuando su significado es de “SER” en español:

- *A computer is an electronic device.*

3. How to recognize a definition

c. Otro método muy común de distinguir una definición y/o explicación es siguiendo el método anterior y dando algunas características distintivas:

- *A computer is an electronic device which/that processes information.*

d. Una de las formas mas frecuentes de dar una definición o explicación es usar dos sustantivos (frases nominales) en oposición, separadas por comas.

- *Computers, electronic devices for processing information are now used in practically every aspect of life.*

THE END